

Standards Board Operating Rules

1. Mandate of the Standards Board

The Standards Board is the sovereign technical authority responsible for:

- Maintaining the MPM Standard
- Approving revisions
- Defining derivative module classes
- Managing the safety envelope
- Issuing ratification packets

It is the only body authorized to modify the core mechanical interface.

2. Composition and Roles

The Standards Board consists of:

- **Chair (Founder-Architect)**
- Mechanical engineering representatives
- Safety engineering representatives
- Manufacturing representatives
- Firmware/timing logic representatives

The Chair sets agendas, oversees ratification, and holds veto authority.

3. Proposal Submission Process

Any member may submit a proposal for:

- Mechanical interface changes
- Safety envelope modifications
- New module classes
- Compliance test updates

Proposals must include:

- Technical rationale
- Safety case
- Impact analysis
- Draft specification text

4. Review and Deliberation Process

The Board follows a structured review process:

1. **Initial Screening** — Chair determines scope and relevance
2. **Technical Review** — Assigned reviewers evaluate feasibility
3. **Safety Review** — Compliance Authority evaluates risk
4. **Public Comment Period** — 30–60 days
5. **Final Deliberation** — Board votes on adoption

5. Voting Procedures

- Simple majority for non-safety changes
- Supermajority for safety envelope changes
- Founder-Architect veto applies to geometry, safety, and licensing
- Abstentions do not count toward quorum

6. Emergency Actions

In cases of:

- Catastrophic mechanical failure
- Safety envelope breach
- Global interoperability risk

The Chair may issue an **Emergency Technical Directive (ETD)**, temporarily modifying the standard until formal review.

7. Publication Rules

All approved changes must be:

- Published in the MPMC repository
- Versioned according to MPM rules
- Accompanied by a rationale and safety case

- Announced to all members

8. Transparency and Recordkeeping

The Board maintains:

- Minutes of all meetings
- Public change logs
- Version history
- Safety case archives
- Compliance test updates

These records form the institutional memory of the standard.